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NVIDIA Corp (NVDA.O)

Groq Deal: Doubling Down on the Inference Inflection

CITI'S TAKE

Nvidia has announced an [agreement to a nonexclusive licensing deal with prominent AI chip startup Groq](#) for \$20bn or ~3x the most recent valuation (Bloomberg, 12/24/25). Following the deal, Groq's founder and president will both leave the startup to join Nvidia. We view the deal as a clear positive on two fronts: (1) We think via this deal, which comes after Nvidia's Rubin CPX GPU announcement in September, Nvidia is indirectly acknowledging that specialized inference architectures are important for real-time and cost-efficient AI deployments to address competition from TPUs and perhaps to a lesser extent upcoming startups. (2) We believe a licensing deal is more adequate vs. a full acquisition. By simply doing a licensing deal and letting Groq still run as an independent company, Nvidia may have worked around regulatory scrutiny. We expect more details at CES where we are hosting a meeting with the investors. Maintain Buy/\$270 TP.

Hyperscale Inference Demand to Double Every Six Months: At re-Invent in early December, AWS announced an episodic memory functionality to its Bedrock AgentCore platform to understand the context of a current interaction. This followed Google's [Nested Learning](#) approach to machine learning in early November and ambitions to double its AI compute capacity every six months. **We believe this shift to massive context inference bodes well for both GPU/XPU demand.** Moreover, the two hyperscale updates follow Nvidia's [Rubin CPX GPU announcement](#) at the AI Infrastructure Summit in early September. With an estimated 3x reduction in TCO through the use of cost-efficient GDDR7 memory vs. the more expensive HBM, Rubin CPX is designed to address the inference heavy workloads. **Groq's language processing units (LPUs) are designed only for inference real-time responses and focus on ultra-low latency/efficiency moving tokens through language models quickly.** By licensing Groq's IP, Nvidia can swiftly add more inference-optimized compute stacks to its road map without building the technology from the ground up.

Buy

Price (24 Dec 25 16:00)	US\$188.61
Target price	US\$270.00
Expected share price return	43.2%
Expected dividend yield	0.0%
Expected total return	43.2%
Market Cap	US\$4,583,223M

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See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations

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NVIDIA Corp

Valuation

Our price target for NVDA of \$270 is based on ~30x P/E on C27E earnings power of \$10 discounted back. Our 30x P/E multiple is in-line with 3-5 year average.

Risks

Downside risks to the attainment of our target price include: 1) competition on gaming could drive the stock lower if Nvidia loses market share; 2) slower-than-expected adoption of new platforms can drive lower data center and gaming sales; 3) lumpiness in auto and data center markets can add volatility to the stock/multiple; and 4) cryptomining impact on gaming sales.

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Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Atif Malik



Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1 23-Feb-23 02:35:10	1	*24.50	23.66
2 17-Mar-23 06:01:34	1	*30.50	25.73
3 23-May-23 08:08:33	1	*36.30	30.69
4 25-May-23 02:22:12	1	*42.00	37.98
5 17-Jul-23 01:50:06	1	*52.00	46.46
6 24-Aug-23 02:36:33	1	*63.00	47.16
7 18-Oct-23 00:32:40	1	*57.50	42.20
8 22-Feb-24 02:01:24	1	*82.00	78.54

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
9 20-Mar-24 06:26:15	1	*103.00	90.37
10 23-May-24 02:55:03	1	*126.00	103.80
11 26-Jun-24 05:00:00	1	*150.00	126.40
12 12-Nov-24 08:00:00	1	*170.00	148.29
13 21-Nov-24 05:00:00	1	*175.00	146.67
14 05-Feb-25 08:00:00	1	*163.00	124.83
15 10-Apr-25 22:30:00	1	*150.00	107.57
16 29-May-25 01:37:50	1	*180.00	139.19

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
17 07-Jul-25 02:00:00	1	*190.00	158.24
18 28-Aug-25 01:41:01	1	*210.00	180.17
19 08-Sep-25 02:00:00	1	*200.00	168.31
20 30-Sep-25 04:04:43	1	*210.00	186.58
21 10-Nov-25 06:11:57	1	*220.00	199.05
22 20-Nov-25 02:46:50	1	*270.00	180.64

*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

NVIDIA Corp (NVDA)
Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Atif Malik



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	11-Dec-23 08:11:55	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	46.63
2	10-Jan-24 11:06:14	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	54.35
3	15-Apr-24 01:00:00	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	86.00
4	16-Jun-24 21:00:00	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	131.88
5	22-Jul-24 01:00:00	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	123.54
6	04-Aug-24 14:08:32	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	107.27
7	21-Nov-24 00:00:00	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	146.67
8	14-Jan-25 02:06:50	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	131.76
9	10-Nov-25 01:11:57	Add STV	Upside	30 Days	199.05
10	10-Dec-25 11:07:18	Remove STV	Upside	30 Days	183.78

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

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